

Thomas (Hyunseung) Lee

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EXPERIENCE

KOSTAT Statistics Data Center

Seoul, South Korea

Dissertation Research (Seoul National University, M.A.)

Nov 2023 — Present

Reallocation Channel of a Minimum-Wage Shock (Nov 2024 — Present)

- Originated as independent research proposal in Advanced Studies in Labor Economics course; evolved into master's thesis demonstrating ability to identify novel research questions and execute large-scale empirical analysis
- Found that minimum-wage increases induced worker transitions toward higher-paying, more productive firms using nationwide employer-employee panel (2015–2020, 300M+ observations), providing supportive evidence for reallocation channels
- Discovered that regional business cycles moderate reallocation effects: workers in stronger economies transition upward while weaker regions face employment losses—providing first empirical evidence that reallocation patterns depend on local economic conditions, a mechanism unexplored in existing literature

Family-Friendly Firms and the Motherhood Penalty (Nov 2023 — Present)

- Coauthored working paper "Sorting of Working Parents into Family-Friendly Firms," with primary responsibility for empirical analysis using proportional hazards models, event-study, and DiD designs on administrative data.
- Leading a follow-up study using causal forests to develop a data-driven definition of “family-friendly” benefits and estimate heterogeneous treatment effects of 50+ amenities on post-childbirth employment outcomes and the motherhood penalty.
- Identified that flexible work arrangements, on-site childcare, and remote-work options substantially reduce post-childbirth employment and earnings decline, providing evidence-based recommendations for gender equity policy

Viva Republica (Toss) — South Korea's leading fintech company

Seoul, South Korea

Data Analyst → Product Manager

Aug 2021 — Sep 2023

Product Teams (Jan 2023 — Sep 2023)

- Identified organization-wide data literacy gap and designed internal analytics product; launched Retention Chart dashboards that increased adoption among non-data teams by 5×
- Proposed and prototyped restaurant recommender feature using credit card re-purchase rates as satisfaction proxy; achieved 30% one-week retention, validating product-market fit and informing future recommendation strategies

Global Team – Vietnam (Jul 2022 — Jan 2023)

- Discovered absence of retention plateau in pedometer-based rewards service through cohort analysis, revealing weak user stickiness and redirecting product strategy from ad-reward models toward sustainable retention mechanisms
- Analyzed credit card issuance funnel and identified 60% drop-off at ID verification; redesigned flow and implemented automated re-engagement, increasing completion rate by 30%

Product Strategy & Analysis Team (Aug 2021 — Jul 2022)

- Designed difference-in-differences inspired engagement metric to measure each product's causal contribution to total app usage; deployed via company-wide dashboards, becoming primary indicator for strategic resource allocation decisions
- Quantified causal impact of integrating banking and securities subsidiaries into main app during transition to financial super-app, measuring engagement uplift and increased activation of core services

Wisely — Fast-growing direct-to-consumer grooming startup

Seoul, South Korea

Data Analyst Intern, Insight & Data Team

Mar 2021 — Jun 2021

- Automated Net Promoter Score and sentiment analysis pipelines to quantify customer feedback and built real-time dashboards

Samsung Asset Management

Seoul, South Korea

Financial Analyst Intern, Liability-Driven Investment Domestic Fixed Income Team

Aug 2020 — Sep 2020

- Valued subordinated capital securities to estimate credit-adjusted yields; analysis adopted for actual investment decisions

EDUCATION

Seoul National University

Seoul, South Korea

M.A. in Economics, Advisor: Prof. Jungmin Lee

Mar 2024 — Aug 2026 (expected)

*Brain Korea 21 Scholarship, Seoul National University

Mar 2024 — Feb 2026

Seoul National University

Seoul, South Korea

B.A. in Economics

Mar 2015 — Feb 2022

*Military Service: Republic of Korea Air Force

Aug 2016 — Aug 2018

ACTIVITIES & SKILLS

SNU Growth Hackers (Data Science Club, 2021): Project Manager, industry-academic ML collaborations with startups

SNU Debate Association (English Debate Club, 2015-16): National Rookie Champion, British Parliamentary debate

Languages: Korean (Native), English (Fluent; TOEFL 107)

Statistics: Causal Inference, Causal ML, Econometrics, Experimental Design, A/B Testing

Programming: Python, SQL, R, Stata; **Analytics Tools:** Tableau, Amplitude, Mixpanel

Updated: December 2025